

# Day 7: The "Open to Work" Trap

## Morning Post (Educational)

### LinkedIn Post

Placing the green "Open to Work" badge on your LinkedIn profile photo does not attract recruiters. It repels them.

Many job seekers believe the badge signals availability and helps them get noticed. In reality, it can signal desperation. Recruiters are looking for in-demand talent, and high-value candidates are rarely positioned as desperate.

Recruiters don't search for "open to work" candidates. They search for specific skills, job titles, and expertise. If your profile headline says "Unemployed | Open to Work," you are missing the opportunity to show what you can actually do.

Remove the green badge. Optimize your headline to show your specific expertise and the value you deliver. Change "Actively seeking new opportunities" to "B2B Sales Representative | Helping SaaS companies scale outbound sales."

I've reviewed dozens of CVs and LinkedIn profiles, and those with focused, value-driven headlines receive far more inbound recruiter inquiries.

Position yourself as an active asset, not a job seeker waiting for a favor. You can use AI to identify the exact keywords recruiters search for in your industry.

If this sounds familiar, I'll be teaching the complete workflow inside my upcoming AI Job Seeker Workshop. Seats are limited.

### Handwritten Visual

#### Handwritten Visual Text

"Position yourself as an asset, not a job seeker."

#### AI Visual Prompt

Minimalist overhead photo of clean white paper. The sentence is handwritten neatly in thick black marker. Natural lighting. No hands. No notebook. No decorations. High contrast. Mobile friendly. Lots of white space. Instagram and LinkedIn optimized.

## Repurposed Formats

### LinkedIn Carousel

- **Slide 1:** Title: The "Open to Work" Mistake.
- **Slide 2:** The Badge: Why the green banner might be hurting your profile.
- **Slide 3:** The Search: Recruiters search for skills and titles, not availability.
- **Slide 4:** The Fix: Use your headline to show your niche and the business results you deliver.
- **Slide 5:** Register: AI Job Seeker Workshop. Workshop registration link: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

### WhatsApp Status

- **Slide 1:** Recruiters search for expertise, not unemployment. Remove the "Open to Work" badge.
- **Slide 2:** Learn how to write a high-converting LinkedIn headline with AI. Workshop registration link: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

### Facebook Post

Placing the green "Open to Work" badge on your LinkedIn profile photo does not attract recruiters. It repels them.

Recruiters search for skills and expertise, not availability. If your headline says "Open to Work," you are wasting valuable space. Change it to show what problems you solve. I've reviewed dozens of CVs and profiles, and value-driven profiles get more messages.

I'm showing how to optimize your professional positioning at the AI Job Seeker Workshop. Workshop registration link: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

### X Thread

- 1/ The green "Open to Work" badge on LinkedIn might be keeping you unemployed. Here is why you should remove it today. ■
- 2/ Job seekers think it helps them stand out. But psychologically, it can signal desperation to hiring managers.
- 3/ Recruiters don't search LinkedIn using "open to work" filters. They search by job titles, technologies, and skills.
- 4/ A headline like "Unemployed | Open to Work" tells recruiters nothing about your capabilities.
- 5/ The fix: Rewrite your headline to state your target role and the value you bring.
- 6/ I've reviewed dozens of CVs and LinkedIn profiles, and positioning always beats availability.
- 7/ Learn how to position yourself as an authority. AI Job Seeker Workshop details: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

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## Afternoon Post (Story / Case Study)

### LinkedIn Post

She had the "Open to Work" badge for six months. Total recruiter messages: Zero.

She believed the Kenyan job market was completely dead and that recruiters were ignoring applications. The issue was her positioning. Her profile made her look like she was willing to do anything, which meant she specialized in nothing.

Recruiters don't hire generalists who want "any" job. They hire specialists who can solve a specific problem.

We removed the green badge. We rewrote her headline to focus on operations management and optimized her "About" section with keywords representing her actual project delivery metrics.

One of my clients got hired this week after we repositioned her from "actively seeking opportunities" to a focused operations expert.

Stop pleading for roles. Start positioning your expertise so recruiters seek you out.

If you're serious about improving your applications, I'll show the exact system during the workshop.

## Handwritten Visual

### Handwritten Visual Text

"Generalists get ignored. Specialists get hired."

### AI Visual Prompt

Minimalist overhead photo of clean white paper. The sentence is handwritten neatly in thick black marker. Natural lighting. No hands. No notebook. No decorations. High contrast. Mobile friendly. Lots of white space. Instagram and LinkedIn optimized.

## Repurposed Formats

### LinkedIn Carousel

- **Slide 1:** Title: Hired after removing the badge.
- **Slide 2:** The Client: Had the "Open to Work" badge for 6 months with no results.
- **Slide 3:** The Issue: Her headline positioned her as a generalist seeking anything.
- **Slide 4:** The Solution: Focused her headline on Operations and added project metrics.
- **Slide 5:** The Result: Inbound recruiter messages led to a hire. Learn the workflow in my workshop. Workshop registration link: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

### WhatsApp Status

- **Slide 1:** My client spent 6 months seeking "any job" with no callbacks. We changed her positioning.
- **Slide 2:** She got hired this week. Learn how to position your expertise. Workshop registration link: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

### Facebook Post

She had the "Open to Work" badge for six months. Total recruiter messages: Zero.

She was ready to quit, thinking the market was dead. Her issue was trying to please everyone, which meant she stood out to no one. We removed the badge, focused her headline on Operations, and added metrics. One of my clients got hired this week after this shift.

Stop pleading for roles. Join the AI Job Seeker Workshop to learn positioning. Workshop registration link: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

### X Thread

1/ She had the "Open to Work" badge for six months. Total recruiter messages: Zero. Here is how we turned her profile around. ■

2/ She thought the market was dead. The real issue: Her profile was positioned as a generalist ready for "any" opportunity.

- 3/ Recruiters search for specialists to solve specific issues. A generalist fits no search criteria.
  - 4/ We removed the green badge. We rewrote her headline to focus on Operations Management.
  - 5/ One of my clients got hired this week after we fixed her positioning.
  - 6/ Position yourself as an authority, not a generalist.
  - 7/ Learn how to run a positioning audit with AI at the AI Job Seeker Workshop. Workshop registration link: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>
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## Evening Post (Workshop Invitation)

### LinkedIn Post

Recruiting is about positioning, not pleading.

Many job seekers write long, emotional posts asking for jobs. While this may get likes, it often ruins their leverage when negotiating salaries with employers.

You want companies to see you as a valuable asset they need to compete for, not someone who is asking for a favor.

Use AI to audit your LinkedIn profile and align your positioning to what hiring managers in your field are actively searching for.

I've worked with over 10 professionals to restructure their LinkedIn profiles and CVs for high-value positioning.

I'm showing how to run this positioning audit during my upcoming workshop.

Workshop registration link: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

### Handwritten Visual

#### Handwritten Visual Text

"Build leverage through positioning, not pleading."

#### AI Visual Prompt

Minimalist overhead photo of clean white paper. The sentence is handwritten neatly in thick black marker. Natural lighting. No hands. No notebook. No decorations. High contrast. Mobile friendly. Lots of white space. Instagram and LinkedIn optimized.

## Repurposed Formats

### LinkedIn Carousel

- **Slide 1:** Title: The Positioning Audit.
- **Slide 2:** The Mistake: Pleading for jobs online, which destroys your salary negotiation leverage.

- **Slide 3:** The Strategy: Restructure your profile to look like an active consultant/expert.
- **Slide 4:** The Process: Run an AI audit to align your profile with hiring manager searches.
- **Slide 5:** Save Your Seat: AI Job Seeker Workshop. Workshop registration link: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

### WhatsApp Status

- **Slide 1:** Pleading for a job ruins your salary leverage. Position yourself as an asset instead.
- **Slide 2:** Learn how to audit your positioning with AI. Workshop registration link: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

### Facebook Post

Recruiting is about positioning, not pleading.

Emotional posts asking for work might get likes, but they hurt your leverage. You want companies to compete for your skills. Use AI to audit your LinkedIn profile positioning. I've worked with over 10 professionals to restructure their profiles.

Learn the system. The AI Job Seeker Workshop registration link: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

### X Thread

- 1/ Recruiting is about positioning, not pleading. Pleading for jobs ruins your leverage. ■
- 2/ If you look desperate, companies will lowball you or ignore you.
- 3/ You want to be seen as an active solution to their business problems.
- 4/ You can use AI to audit your profile positioning and align it with active searches.
- 5/ I've worked with over 10 professionals to transition their profiles to high-value assets.
- 6/ I am showing this exact auditing system in my upcoming workshop.
- 7/ AI Job Seeker Workshop registration link: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>